- Global controls enforced by ACME's PEP/PDP ensure platform-wide governance
- Tenant-specific ReBAC controls enforced within each tenant's environment

The flow in Figure 13.2 illustrates how every authorization decision in C³ passes through two enforcement layers, but it shows only a single request in motion. In practice, those enforcement points aren't limited to one location—they are distributed throughout the platform. Some are at the API gateway, performing coarse-grained checks before requests reach any tenant. Others are embedded within services, enforcing fine-grained actions on documents, folders, and workspaces. The next section examines where these Policy Enforcement Points are situated in the C³ stack, how they vary in scope, and how each plays a role in maintaining a consistent policy evaluation pipeline.

POLICY STORES AND POLICY IDS

As we saw in Chapter 7, externalized authorization systems rely on a Policy Administration Point (PAP), the component responsible for creating, storing, and distributing policies to the engines that evaluate them. In C³, the PAP takes the form of a central policy store that manages both platform-wide and tenant-specific policies.

Policies are logically separated by `tenant_id`, and the distribution service delivers only the relevant bundle to each PDP, whether it's the shared multi-tenant cluster or a tenant's dedicated instance. This method maintains strict data isolation while streamlining policy management and ensuring consistency across the platform. Logical separation in the policy store ensures that, while evaluation is centralized, accountability stays per-tenant, maintaining both operational efficiency and clear governance boundaries.

Each policy in the store has a unique `policy_id` that tracks it throughout its entire lifecycle—from creation to evaluation and auditing. When a PEP receives a decision from a PDP, that ID appears in the decision log, linking every action to the specific policy text that generated it.